Section III

Mr. Fogg and Sir Francis Cromarty, after searching the village from end to end, came back without having found anything.

'I shall go on foot,' said Phileas Fogg.

Passepartout, who had now rejoined his master, made an unhappy face, as he thought of his magnificent Indian shoes. Happily he too had been looking about him, and, after a moment's **hesitation**, said, 'Monsieur, I think I have found a means of **conveyance**.'

'What?'

'An elephant! An elephant that belongs to an Indian who lives but a hundred steps from here.'

Kiouni—this was the name of the animal—could doubtless travel **rapidly** for a long time, and, in the absence of any other means of transport, Mr. Fogg resolved to hire him.

When therefore Mr. Fogg proposed this to the elephant's owner, he refused **point-blank**. Mr. Fogg **persisted**, offering the excessive sum of ten pounds an hour for the loan of the animal to Allahabad. **Refused**. Twenty pounds? Refused also. Forty pounds? Still refused.

Phileas Fogg, without getting in the least **flurried**, then proposed to purchase the animal outright, and at first offered a thousand pounds for him. The owner, perhaps thinking he was going to make a great bargain, still refused.

Mr. Fogg offered first twelve hundred, then fifteen hundred, eighteen hundred, two thousand pounds. Passepartout was fairly white with suspense. At two thousand pounds the man **yielded**.

'Good heavens, what a price for an elephant!' cried Passepartout.

A young man, with an intelligent face, offered his services as a guide, which Mr. Fogg accepted, promising so generous a reward as to greatly increased his zeal. The elephant was led out and equipped.

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